

Sam Wells

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PROFILE

Graduate student in Rural Planning and Development with experience in GIS-based asset management, spatial data organization, and municipal infrastructure records. Skilled in ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Excel, Access, SQL, VBA, Python, and MESH, with experience managing large infrastructure datasets, verifying spatial records, geocoding addresses, improving database workflows, and translating technical analysis into clear reports and presentations.

EXPERIENCE

City of Woodstock

April 2026 - Present

Water Records Maintenance

Woodstock, ON

- Managed and validated more than 30,000 municipal water infrastructure records, improving data accuracy for asset mapping, maintenance planning, and coordination between the City of Woodstock and Oxford County.
- Integrated and cross-validated asset data across MESH, GIS, Microsoft Access, Excel, service cards and address records by resolving duplicate, incomplete, outdated and incorrectly mapped records.
- Developed Access forms, SQL queries, sub forms, and VBA automation that reduced repetitive data entry and accelerated updates to work dates and maintenance histories.
- Geocoded and reverse-matched addresses in collaboration with GIS staff to verify infrastructure locations and improve alignment between municipal asset records and spatial data.

Grand River Conservation Authority

June 2022 – September 2025 (Seasonal)

Assistant Head Lifeguard | Lifeguard

Brantford, ON

- Supervised a team of more than 20 lifeguards, coordinating daily operations, staff assignments, and compliance with safety and emergency-response procedures.
- Planned and delivered biweekly training in rescue techniques, first aid, and emergency response to maintain National Lifeguard standards and improve staff preparedness.
- Maintained incident reports, training records, and operational documentation to support regulatory compliance, risk management, and organizational accountability.

EDUCATION

University of Guelph

September 2025 – Present

Master of Science in Rural Planning and Development

Guelph, ON

- Cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0 (89%)
- Graduate Student Council Representative, Canadian Institute of Planners Liaison

Wilfrid Laurier University

September 2021 – April 2025

Honours Bachelor of Arts, History with Geography Minor

Waterloo, ON

- Cumulative GPA: $\approx 3.6/4.0$ ($\approx 81\%$)

GIS, RESEARCH & ANALYTICAL EXPERIENCE

- **Agricultural Systems Approach:** Evaluated Oxford County's agricultural land-use system using provincial planning policy, municipal Official Plan materials, and spatial analysis to identify implementation considerations for agricultural protection, land-use compatibility, and regional planning.
- **Greyfield Finder:** Developed a web-based GIS tool using Python, FastAPI, and OpenStreetMap data to identify and rank surface parking lots with redevelopment potential.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- GIS & Spatial Analysis: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, geocoding, reverse geocoding, spatial verification, asset mapping
- Data & Database Management: Microsoft Excel, Access, MESH, SQL, VBA, Python, CSV management, data validation
- Research & Analysis: RStudio, SPSS, NVivo, Qualtrics, census analysis, policy analysis, program evaluation
- Certifications: Ontario G Driver's Licence, Standard First Aid & CPR-C